

Styrax portoricensis

palo de jazmin

Family (Styracaceae)

Kingdom (Plantae)

Status (Endangered)

Description

An evergreen tree that grows to a height of 10 to 12 meters. It has simple, glossy leaves, with a lighter-colored, scaly underside. Its white flowers grow in clusters and develop into a drupe-like fruit containing a single seed. It is distinguished by its complex floral structure and elongated fruit.



Location/Habitat



Found in the Luquillo Mountains of Puerto Rico, within the Caribbean National Forest. It occurs primarily in the palo colorado forest, an evergreen forest at elevations above 600 meters, characterized by steep, acidic soils and dense canopy vegetation.